03

Troubleshooting Manual

Diagnose, repair and verify

EDITION 1.1 | 28 OCTOBER 2026 | BASELINE d623cce

READERS / Operators + technicians

Stop safely before diagnosis.

Prepared for the October 28 prototype session. Physical acceptance is pending.

IN THIS GUIDE

Start here: safe diagnosis 02

The app is empty or has old readings 03

Login, PIN and claim failures 04

Device offline or controller not responding 05

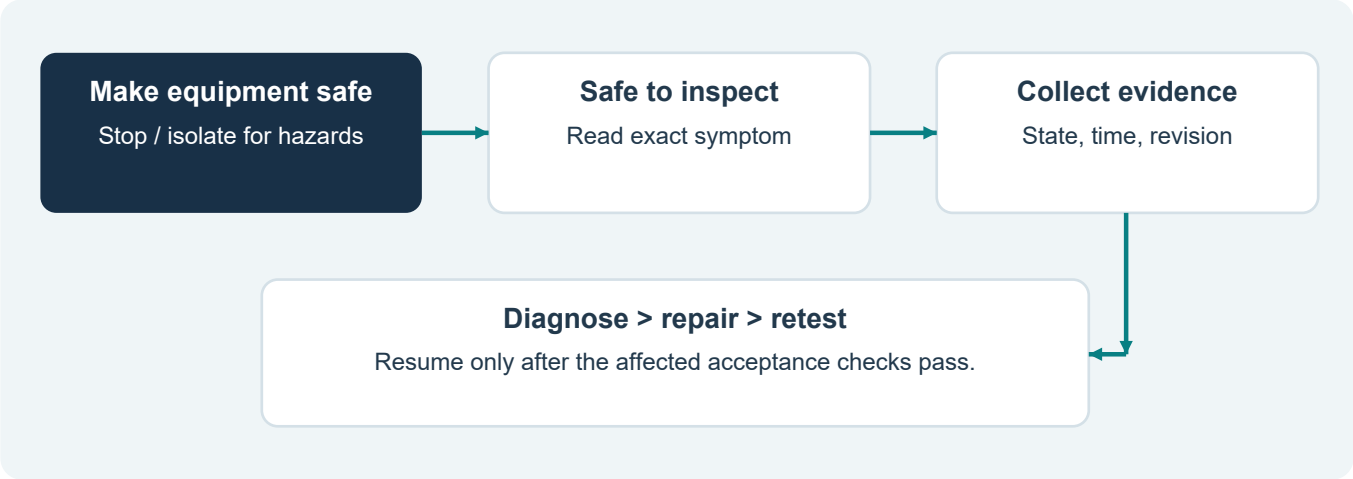
Commands and schedules fail 06

Sensor, motion and display faults 07

Logs, notifications, APK and upload problems 08

Record, repair and release 09

Start here: safe diagnosis



If there is unexpected motion, overheating, exposed wiring, a jam, wrong direction or a failed stop, use the physical E-stop and the approved power-isolation procedure. Keep the mechanism stopped for the technician. Do not troubleshoot by reaching into a moving hopper or bypassing a switch.

Capture the problem before changing anything

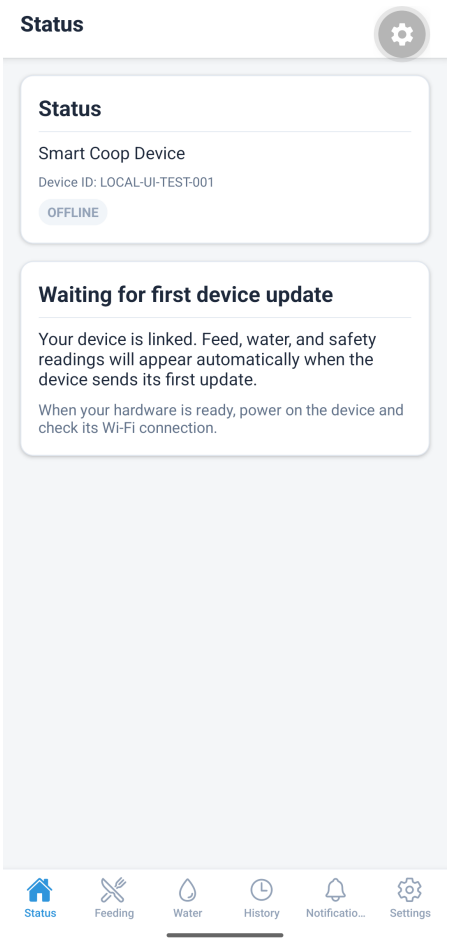
1. Record the Device ID, date/time, app version, firmware revision and the exact screen or serial error. Use a redacted screenshot where useful.
2. Note whether the phone has internet, whether the ESP32 is online, and whether the Mega is responding. These are separate facts.
3. Check the last update time. Old data, zero values and missing data are different states.
4. Make one justified change at a time. Repeat the relevant check and record the result.

Symptom	Start on page
Empty app, first update missing, device unavailable	3
Claim denied, lost PIN, login error	4
Offline device or controller not responding	5
Manual feed or schedule not working	6
Wrong weight, hopper, water or display readings	7
Logs, alerts, installation or upload problems	8
Record evidence and decide whether to resume	9

This guide is for the commissioning baseline of 27 October 2026. No physical HIT test has passed in that baseline. Examples of software behavior do not establish that the actual wiring or motor system is safe.

Source: hardware-test-day-run-sheet.md; development-status.md.

The app is empty or has old readings



Linked demo device awaiting data

SCREEN GUIDE

01 Waiting for first device update means ownership was found but no first device readings are available.

02 OFFLINE is expected when the board is not powered or connected. Claiming alone does not make the device online.

03 LOCAL-UI-TEST-001 is an emulator example ID. Enter the actual configured Device ID during setup.

04 This screen is different from a loading error. Do not add fake cloud readings to make a production screen appear populated.

Historical Android emulator capture. Simulated values only; visual details may differ from the installed APK.

What you see	Check	Expected recovery
Waiting for first device update	Technician checks ESP32 Wi-Fi, Auth binding, network time, Mega UART and state writes.	First valid device state fills the cards.
Could not load device data	Phone internet, signed-in owner, correct project/build and database permission error.	Correct access or network issue, then retry.
Device unavailable	Account ownership lookup and device record. Do not switch randomly between accounts.	Correct owner can load the linked device.
Old timestamp / OFFLINE	Power, Wi-Fi and last heartbeat; see page 5.	Fresh heartbeat and fresh state return.

A fresh installation can have no history, no alerts and no cloud readings. Those states are not automatically an app defect. Conversely, a permission error or indefinite loading is not a valid empty state and should be recorded as a fault.

Source: mobile-empty-state-qa-2026-10-26.md; translations.ts; AuthContext and RTDB service.

Login, PIN and claim failures

Claim denied

The app uses the same message for an invalid Device ID, an incorrect PIN or an already claimed device. The administrator must inspect the exact condition; the message alone does not identify it.

1. Confirm the production APK and the intended Firebase project. A local-emulator PIN does not provision production.
2. Enter the exact Device ID, including case. The prototype is configured as **device-001**; check for keyboard capitalization or spaces.
3. Confirm that the private PIN contains six digits and that the database value is a string. Preserve leading zeros. There is no universal default PIN.
4. Have the administrator inspect **devices/device-001/ownerId** and **claimRequests/device-001**. A two-step claim can leave evidence even if the app reports a failure.
5. If another owner already holds the device, use the approved transfer procedure. Do not delete ownership as a shortcut or relax database rules.

Login and account diagnosis

Problem	Safe next step
Email/password rejected in the phone	Use the owner account, not the ESP32 account. Confirm the email and password privately; follow the administrator's account-recovery process.
Password reset email does not arrive	On the production Login screen, enter the exact owner-account email and tap **Forgot password?**. Check Firebase Authentication / Users for that exact address, then check Inbox, Spam and filtered mail. A local Auth Emulator does not send production email. The app's generic confirmation does not prove that the account exists.
ESP32 sign-in fails	Technician compares the dedicated device account with ignored Config.h and the bound deviceAuthUid. Reset only the authorized device account if necessary.
Email already in use	Sign in to the existing intended account or recover it. Do not create variants that obscure ownership.
API key / application restriction error	Administrator verifies the selected project's active key restrictions against the SDK and ESP32 REST requirements. Do not remove all restrictions or disclose the key in a report.
PIN lost	Authorized administrator securely sets a new six-digit string and hands it to the intended owner privately. Follow transfer steps if ownership changes.

RETAINED CLAIM RECORD

The current implementation can retain the submitted PIN in claimRequests. Never paste this record into a ticket or screenshot. After ownership is verified, the administrator may remove the retained request. A transfer must address both the old ownerId and the old request.

Source: device-provisioning-guide.md; ClaimDeviceScreen.tsx; rtdbService; RTDB rules.

Device offline or controller not responding



Find the first broken link. Check identity, freshness and valid data at each step.

An online ESP32 can coexist with an unresponsive Mega.

Phone and backend checks

Verify phone internet and the correct signed-in owner. Check the last heartbeat and state timestamps through the app or authorized console. A cached ONLINE label is not enough. App offline detection occurs after 90 seconds without a fresh heartbeat, with periodic checks.

ESP32 checks - technician

With actuator power disconnected, check board power and redacted serial output. Confirm the 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi settings were entered privately and the ESP32 was rebuilt afterward. The prepared baseline image still used Wi-Fi placeholders.

Confirm the dedicated account can authenticate and its UID matches deviceAuthUid. Check network time, TLS and authorized database writes. Firebase writes wait for valid network time; successful Wi-Fi association alone is insufficient. Keep Core Debug Level at None and do not disable certificate validation to hide a TLS failure.

Mega link checks - technician

If the ESP32 is online but the controller is NOT RESPONDING, inspect Mega power, UART wiring and baud rates. Isolate power before changing wires. Confirm Mega TX1 18 reaches ESP32 RX2 16 through appropriate level protection, and ESP32 TX2 17 reaches Mega RX1 19. Check grounds and the actual signal levels.

The ESP32 marks the controller absent after 30 seconds of Mega silence. The Mega expires ESP32 status after 15 seconds. Capture redacted complete lines and check newline framing. Do not diagnose reliability from one successful packet: run the disconnect/reconnect and prolonged-link checks in HIT-04.

Recovery test

After correction, verify fresh state and heartbeat, a responding controller, schedule delivery and a safe command lifecycle with actuator loads disconnected. Then repeat the affected hardware checks before powered motion.

Source: HyFePoul_ESP32.ino; ESP32Communication.ino; notifications.md; HIT-03 / HIT-04.

Commands and schedules fail

Result / reason	Meaning	Next action
Waiting for device	Command queued; execution is not confirmed.	Check fresh heartbeat and controller response. Avoid repeated submissions.
ESTOP_ACTIVE	Stop latch is active.	Correct the cause, release the physical button, then authorized reset.
PHYSICAL_ESTOP_ENGAGED	Button is still sensed pressed.	Inspect button/wiring safely; do not force a reset.
FEEDING_ACTIVE	A cycle is already running.	Observe it; do not start a second cycle.
HOPPER_LOW / HOPPER_EMPTY	Insufficient hopper level or empty during a cycle.	Refill safely and verify the ultrasonic measurement.
UART_TIMEOUT	No Mega acknowledgement within 3 s.	Inspect link and controller. Determine physical state before retry.
EXECUTION_TIMEOUT	No final result within 300 s.	Inspect motion and logs. A timeout is not proof of stopped motors.
TRAY_TIMEOUT	Target not reached in time or scale not responding.	Check load cell, outlet, feed supply and calibration with power isolated.
CHAIN_TIMEOUT / END_LIMIT_EARLY	Travel or limit behavior does not match the expected path.	Stop and isolate; check direction, switches, obstruction and measured timing.
LINE_TOO_LONG / stale command	Protocol line rejected or queued command too old.	Technician investigates command formatting or connectivity; do not edit live command records casually.
NOT_IMPLEMENTED_SAFELY	Remote restart is intentionally rejected.	Use a supervised local shutdown/restart procedure if needed.

Schedule saved, but no feed

Check that the intended slot is enabled and shows ON DEVICE. Confirm the Mega's clock is valid and the local time is correct. Review stop latch, hopper level and whether another feed cycle was active at that time. Saving to the cloud alone is not confirmation that the Mega stored the change.

Inspect EEPROM and restore behavior with motors safely disconnected. Do not solve a missed schedule by repeatedly issuing manual feeds; first determine whether feed was already dispensed. A restart can restore cloud schedules, so review all three slots after reconnecting.

Source: Feeding.ino; ESP32Communication.ino; HyFePoul_ESP32.ino; ScheduleStorage.ino.

Sensor, motion and display faults

Symptom	Likely checks	Verify after correction
Tray NOT READY	HX711 power, DOUT, shared SCK.	Stable raw value; known mass.
Weight implausible	Tare, factor sign/value, load path, tray contact.	Known masses; reboot check.
Tray readings drift	Vibration, shared wiring, grounding, sampling.	Test five channels separately and together.
Hopper percentage wrong	Sensor aim, obstruction, measured empty/full distance.	Empty, full and mid-level readings.
Water LOW when full	Float orientation, pin 34, active-low wiring.	Stable low/full tests; 2 s debounce.
Wrong direction / overshoot	Relay polarity, motor wiring, limits, travel timing.	Stop; repeat unloaded safety check.
Nextion blank or buttons fail	Panel power, TX/RX, ground, 9600 baud, matching TFT and IDs.	HIT-12: check live values and touch controls with actuators disconnected.
Event Log empty / SD unavailable	SD ready; active CSV exists and has events. Scan covers latest 64 KiB.	HIT-12: compare p3 Refresh output with the CSV.
App and Nextion schedules differ	Panel saves EEPROM; cloud restore can replace it. No write-back yet (R-54).	Use app for a schedule that must match remotely.

Weight changes after a feed

Each tray is tared before dispensing. Later readings change with feed use, vibration or movement. During commissioning, compare delivered amounts with an independent scale.

A stop will not reset

Confirm that the physical button is released and the mechanism is safe. If the input remains active, inspect wiring and switch behavior. Do not defeat the input or use a different owner account to work around it. Reset clears the latch; it does not fix the original mechanical or electrical problem.

KEEP FAULTS VISIBLE

Do not increase timeouts, change thresholds or alter calibration solely to suppress an alert. Measure the actual cause, justify the change and rerun the affected HIT checks.

Source: Config.ino; SerialConsole.ino; Nextion.ino; Safety.ino; commissioning procedure.

Logs, notifications, APK and upload problems

No phone notification

Open Notifications and inspect active alerts. Android permission may be denied, the app may be closed or suspended, or the alert may have existed before the app opened. The first snapshot is a baseline and is not re-notified. Only a newer occurrence produces a local notification; resolution does not. There is no deployed server push path for this edition.

Missing SD or monthly history

Check SD initialization and the RTC date before concluding that records are lost. Monthly filenames use UTC. Isolate power before handling the card, preserve existing files and test with a technician-approved compatible card if needed. Do not format the original card before copying required evidence.

Phone Recent data is normally written every 5 minutes and at feed start/end; daily totals are sent after feeds and periodically. Cloud outages or restarts can leave gaps. One record per alert type means repeat incidents may replace the previous cloud timestamp; inspect the SD event sequence where available.

APK will not install or opens the wrong experience

Use the standalone production APK supplied for this edition. It contains the application bundle and does not require Expo Go or Metro. Verify the file checksum with the release record. If Android reports a signature conflict, the existing app may use a different signing certificate; preserve needed information and credentials before deciding whether to uninstall it. Uninstalling deletes local app data.

The current direct-install APK is development-key signed and is not a Play Store release. Do not substitute an emulator build that points at a laptop or local Firebase. Use the Account / Device Setup Manual to verify the production build and owner claim.

Board upload fails

Failure	Check
No port	Data-capable USB cable, board power, driver and operating-system detection.
Port busy	Close serial monitors and other software using that board.
Wrong target / missing core	Confirm Mega versus ESP32 and the installed FQBN/core from the build guide.
Missing library	Restore the documented library version; compile the whole sketch directory.
Old settings still used	Recompile after editing local configuration, then upload that exact output.

Do not randomly change board targets, boot offsets or partition layouts to force an upload. Record the full error with secrets removed and use the installed toolchain guide.

Source: notifications.md; SDLogging.ino; firmware-build-environment.md; development-status.md.

Record, repair and release

Fault report

Device ID: _____ Date/time/timezone: _____

App version / APK checksum reference: _____

Firmware commit / board / wiring revision: _____

Exact symptom and expected result: _____

_____

Last known safe state / physical action taken: _____

_____

Measurements and redacted evidence location: _____

Corrective change: _____

Retest / HIT IDs / result: _____

Technician and reviewer: _____

Resume only when

[ ] The cause has been identified and the corrective action recorded.

[ ] Wiring and configuration agree with the revised documentation.

[ ] The failed test and dependent safety/calibration checks pass physically.

[ ] The actual phone, backend and device agree on identity and status.

[ ] A supervisor approves the next operating step and the operator understands the change.

Use FAIL for an observed failed expectation and BLOCKED when hardware, credentials or a required safe test method is unavailable. Keep the earlier evidence. A simulator result cannot replace the physical retest.

References and edition

Edition 1.1, 28 October 2026. Firmware filenames refer to firmware/arduino-mega/HyFePoul_Arduino/ unless the ESP32 sketch is named. App labels come from mobile-app/src/i18n/translations.ts. Detailed acceptance criteria are in docs/hardware-integration-test-plan.md and docs/hardware-commissioning-procedure.md.

Never include passwords, setup PINs, authentication tokens, private account exports or unredacted claim records in reports, screenshots or Git. Support contact details should be entered in the User's Manual handover card.